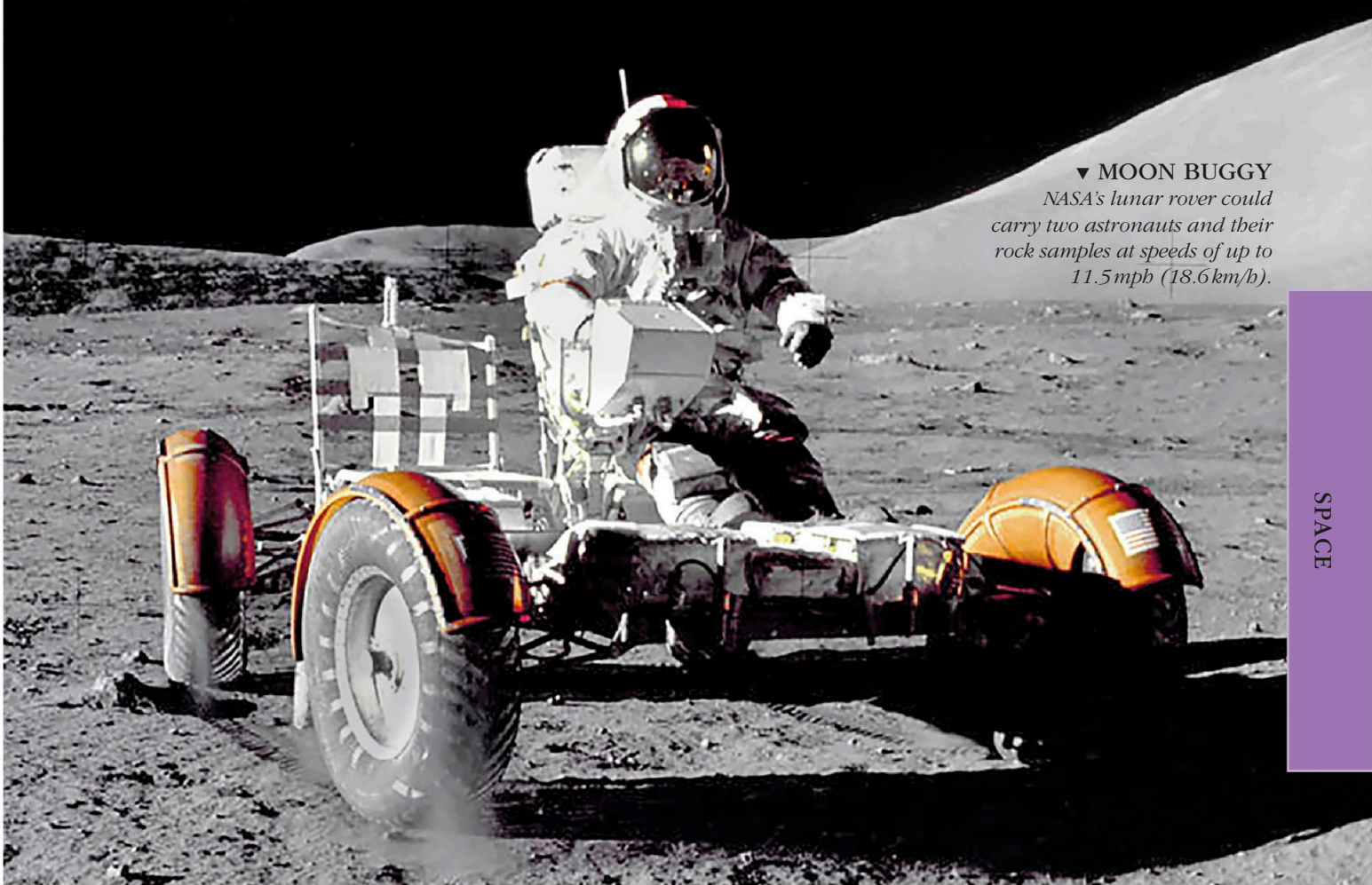




▼ **MOON BUGGY**
 NASA's lunar rover could carry two astronauts and their rock samples at speeds of up to 11.5 mph (18.6 km/h).

Exploring the moon

- **What?** Apollo program
- **Who?** NASA
- **Where and when?** US, 1968–1972

In July 1969, Apollo 11 was the first of eight historic missions that landed astronauts on the moon. The Apollo moon landings presented many new challenges for NASA. The 12 astronauts who walked

on the moon wore special spacesuits designed to supply them with oxygen, protect them from the hazards of the lunar surface, and allow them to set up scientific instruments and collect rock samples. Later Apollo missions carried Lunar Roving Vehicles (LRVs) so that astronauts could explore a far greater area.



Commanders of Apollo and Soyuz spacecraft shake hands in space

Historic handshake

- **What?** Apollo-Soyuz Test Project
- **Who?** Apollo/Soyuz 19
- **Where and when?** US/Russia, 1975

In July 1975, Apollo and Soyuz spacecraft met in orbit and used a special docking module to link the two incompatible systems. This marked the end of the space race between the United States and Russia, but it was not until the 1990s that rendezvous between the Space Shuttle and the Mir space station became regular events.

The first space tourist

- **What?** ISS EP-1 mission
- **Who?** Dennis Tito
- **Where and when?** Russia, 2001

Faced with a cash shortage in the late 1990s, the Russian space agency offered to take paying passengers to orbit. The first, American millionaire Dennis Tito, visited the International Space Station in 2001. Several other tourists flew in the 2000s, but plans for widespread space travel have now been left to commercial promoters.



Dennis Tito (middle)